Lesson 18 material: Reading Profiles 2: Gibson and Valdez

English Stage 1 (B1) · Unit 2: Getting to Know You

1.4: Reading: Profile Gibson

From *Getting to Know You - An Intermediate Integrated-Skills Module for English Learners* by Sara Ferguson, Grossmont College (CC BY-NC-SA). This section: CC BY-NC-SA; authored, remixed or curated by Sara Ferguson.
Original page, with audio and online exercises:
https://human.libretexts.org/Bookshelves/Languages/English_as_a_Second_Language/Getting_to_Know_You_-_An_Intermediate_Integrated-Skills_Module_for_English_Learners_(Ferguson)/01%3A_Chapter_1/1.04%3A_Section_4-
Changes: formatted for print; exercise answers are in the study guide.

Pre-reading Activity

Before you read, discuss the questions below with your classmates.

- What are some majors that students can pursue in college or university?
- Which of these majors are good for people who enjoy adventure?

Skim the student profile and fill out the chart below.

Name of student	Major	Name of profile author	Name of university

Vocabulary Preview

Match the words below with their meanings. Then add -er or -or to create a new word that means "a person who _____"

Word Bank

- Geography
- Photography
- Adventure
- Survey
- Travel
- Hydrography

Definitions

- The science of mapping bodies of water, such as seas, lakes, and rivers
- The study of the physical features of the earth as well as populations, resources, land use, and industries
- To make a journey; to go from one place to another
- The art of taking and processing photographs
- To examine and record an area in order to make a map
- An unusual and exciting activity or experience

- A _____is a person who studies the science of mapping bodies of water, such as seas, lakes, and rivers.
- A _____ is a person who studies the physical features of the earth as well as populations, resources, land use, and industries.
- A _____is a person who makes a journey or goes from one place to another.
- A _____ is a person who practices the art of taking and processing photographs.
- A _____ is a person who examines and records an area in order to make a map.
- An _____is a person who has an unusual and exciting activity or experience.

Student Profile

Student Spotlight--Cody Gibson

June 25, 2014

Geomatics major, Class of 2015

Hometown: Shawnee, Oklahoma

image courtesy Cody Gibson

Did you know that while 24 people have been to the moon, just three have been to the deepest part of the ocean? We have more understanding of the moon's geography than the geography of Earth's sea floor.

"The ocean is only five to eight percent mapped," said Cody Gibson, a geomatics student at the University of Alaska, Anchorage and adventurer who is committed to mapping the mysterious depths of the ocean. The challenge? Average depths of about 14,000 feet--that's 2.65 miles. Cody works for Fugro Pelagos, a company with surveyors around the world who specialize in mapping the sea floor.

Before we learn more of Cody's story, an important question: what does a person studying geomatics do? Besides wear orange vests around campus, of course.

"Essentially we're mapping the Earth, using math, physics, law practices, everything possible," he said.

With just one semester left until his December graduation, Cody is looking forward to committing full-time to Fugro, the company he first connected with as an intern almost two years ago. Geomatics graduates are in such high demand in Alaska, he said, it's rare for a student to graduate without a job offer in hand.

"If they don't have an offer by graduation," he said, "they'll have one in a matter of weeks." Most will end up working in land surveying, but Cody is excited to be working in his specialized field, hydrography, which keeps him out on the water through much of the summer, surveying and outfitting boats with state-of-the-art mapping equipment.

"University of Alaska, Anchorage is my 17th school since I was in first grade," Cody said with a grin. "My mom just liked to travel a lot so we traveled often. She'd start at a new school, I'd start at a new school. She's a teacher--English, drama, music, all sorts of things."

Image courtesy Cody Gibson

UAA is Cody's third college. After graduating from high school in Oregon, he studied photography at Southern Oregon University. After Oregon, he transferred to University of Colorado, Colorado Springs. There he took all their photography courses and started thinking about alternatives. He caught sight of a roadside survey crew and it got him thinking.

He began researching geomatics programs and decided to go to UAA. Alaska sounded like the best adventure, so he headed North.

"I love it. I've spent less than a month out of the state since I moved here," he said.

When he's not working or in class, he's exploring Alaska. He enjoys solo kayaking adventures, hiking, and biking. He keeps a camera close by on his adventures, too. His first summer in Alaska he spent working for an aerial mapping company.

Cody in his kayak. Image courtesy Cody Gibson

If all goes to plan, Cody's next adventures may take him back up in the air to get a better look at the oceans below.

"There's an overlay between hydrography and LIDAR, which is where they shoot lasers down from a plane to map the earth by millions and millions of data points," he explained. "There's a crossover there caller LIDAR bathymetry and that's really what I'm interested in--mapping the ocean with LIDAR."

That's something Fugro does, he said. Geomatics gives him the opportunity to travel around the world. His degree will take him everywhere from Belize to Trinidad to Saudi Arabia for winter work.

Alaska, too, will remain on his list for personal and professional exploration.

"I've only been to a small percentage of Alaska and there's so much left to do," he said. "I came up to Alaska for an adventure and exceeded my expectations by a long shot."

This story written by Jamie Gonzales, UAA Office of University Advancement

cc licensed BY-NC http://greenandgold.uaa.alaska.edu/blog/25497/student-spotlight-cody-gibson/

Comprehension Questions

Read the profile a second time and answer the questions below.

- What company does Cody work for and what do they do?
- Which of the following defines "mapping"?
  - Putting locations on a map
  - Sleeping peacefully in the afternoon
  - Wearing an orange vest around campus
- When will Cody graduate? Where will he work after he graduates?
- What subject did Cody study before he came to the University of Alaska?
- What are some advantages of studying geomatics, according to the profile? Choose all that apply.
  - Jobs in geomatics are easy to find
  - Geomatics is an easy major

- The professors are very nice and helpful
- The jobs in geomatics offer interesting travel
- Geomatics technology is interesting
- People who work in geomatics are active

Writing Interview Questions

When an author writes a profile, they need to conduct an interview first in order to gather information about their subject. The author of this profile is Jamie Gonzalez. Jamie Gonzalez asked Cody about his life, his studies and his future career. What questions do you think Jamie Gonzalez asked?

For each answer, write the questions that the interviewer probably asked Cody. There is more than one possible question for each answer, but try to start your question with the word provided. The first task is completed for you as an example.

- I work for Fugro Pelagos, a company with surveyors around the world who specialize in mapping the seafloor.
  - Question: Where do you work?
- Essentially, we're mapping the Earth, using math, physics, law practices, everything possible.
  - Question: What....
- I first connected with Fugro Pelagros as an intern two years ago.
  - Question: How...
- University of Alaska, Anchorage is my 17th school since I was in first grade.
  - Question: Where...
- My mom just liked to travel a lot so we traveled often.
  - Question: Why...
- I started at Southern Oregon University; then I attended University of Colorado.
  - Question: Where...
- Alaska sounded like the best adventure
  - Question: Why...
- I enjoy solo kayaking adventures, hiking, and biking. I always take my camera.
  - Question: Why...
- Read the last section of the profile, starting at "If all goes to plan..." What question did the interviewer ask to learn all of this information? Write an **open-ended** question.

1.5: Reading: Profile Valdez

From *Getting to Know You - An Intermediate Integrated-Skills Module for English Learners* by Sara Ferguson, Grossmont College (CC BY-NC-SA). This section: CC BY-NC-SA; authored, remixed or curated by Sara Ferguson.
Original page, with audio and online exercises:
https://human.libretexts.org/Bookshelves/Languages/English_as_a_Second_Language/Getting_to_Know_You_-_An_Intermediate_Integrated-Skills_Module_for_English_Learners_(Ferguson)/01%3A_Chapter_1/1.06%3A_Section_6-
Changes: formatted for print; exercise answers are in the study guide.

Pre-reading Activity

Write about or discuss the questions below.

- What do you know about NASA? What do NASA employees do?
- Skim the photos and captions in the reading below for 30 seconds. Who is the article about?
- What can you say about him?

Guided Reading Activity

When you are faced with a particularly challenging reading assignment, sometimes it helps to pause to ask and answer questions after each section or paragraph. In this activity, practice using questioning as a strategy to understand difficult text. Pause and answer the questions after each paragraph.

Felipe Valdez: Life at a Crossroads

(Picture: Felipe Valdez sits in the cockpit of an aircraft)

Figure: NASA's Armstrong Flight Research Center is home to many NASA airplanes. Here, Felipe Valdez sits inside the cockpit of a large aircraft

Many students move away from home when they start college. While some move to a new city or state, NASA intern Felipe Valdez moved to a new country. In 2007, Felipe made the difficult decision to leave his home in Mexico and move to the United States to pursue his education and career. At the time, his life was at a crossroads. He could stay in Mexico, leave school, and find a full-time job, or he could move to the U.S. and have the opportunity to continue his education.

- Where is Felipe Valdez from?
- Why did he decide to move?

After moving to California, Felipe started his sophomore year at River Valley High School in Yuba City, about an hour outside Sacramento. Despite the challenge of integrating into a new culture and learning a new language, Felipe excelled in all his courses and graduated with an excellent GPA.

- Where did Felipe go to high school?
- Was he successful? Identify the clause that gives you the answer to this question

After high school, Felipe began to work on his bachelor's degree. He first attended Yuba Community College where, in addition to earning his associate degree and graduating with honors, he received the Extended Opportunity Programs & Services Student Role model and the Mathematics, Engineering, and Science Achievement Student of the Year awards. He then went on to study at California State

University, Sacramento, where he became heavily involved on campus and received several scholarships. During his time at Sacramento State, Felipe was invited to join the Engineering Honor Society, Tau Beta Pi. He also became a member of the Society of Hispanic Professional Engineers, the MESA Engineering Program, and the Leader Initiative Program.

- Where did Felipe start college?
- Where did Felipe finish college?
- What awards has Felipe won? What subjects is he good at?

After completing his undergraduate degree with honors, Felipe enrolled as a mechanical engineering graduate student at California State University, Sacramento. Here he has had the opportunity to work alongside one of his professors and NASA fellow Dr. Jose Granda on NASA research projects. Granda uses Space Grant funding to fuel NASA student research at the university.

- Where is Felipe studying now?
- Who is mentoring him?

His project with Granda involved designing a control system for the NASA Morpheus space vehicle, a prototype planetary vehicle capable of vertical takeoff and landing. His first goal was to design a control system that allows for the adjustment of the thrust force while maintaining the vehicle's orientation and position only in the vertical direction.

- What is the name of the space vehicle Felipe is working on?
- This paragraph is challenging. Identify the words that you understand and discuss with your classmates. Can you get a general idea about his project?

While completing his internship at NASA's Armstrong Flight Research Center the following semester, Felipe and two other Sacramento State students worked on the next goal, which is the design of a more advanced control system on Morpheus, the very same vehicle he had worked on during his undergraduate research. He aimed to create a system that would allow the vehicle to perform complex maneuvers autonomously.

(Picture: Felipe Valdez poses in front of NASA’s Space Exploration Vehicle)

Figure: Felipe Valdez explored the Mars rock yard at NASA's Armstrong Flight Research Center. Here he poses in front of the Space Exploration Vehicle

- The photo shows a picture of the space vehicle Felipe is working on. What is he trying to improve on the vehicle?

"Felipe is the type of intern most mentors desire," said his NASA mentor, Oscar Murillo. "He is eager to engage in the research, asking questions to figure out the next step, and willing to learn new skills to accomplish the tasks."

Because of his guidance toward a NASA internship, Felipe would like to thank Dr. Granda for inspiring him to pursue an education in STEM. "He motivated, pushed, and helped me," says Felipe. "Thanks to him, I got interested in aerospace engineering and the pursuit of higher education."

- The final two paragraphs have quotation marks. Who is speaking in each paragraph?

Comprehension and Rhetorical Analysis

Answer the questions below.

- This profile is most likely found:
  - In a national newspaper
  - On the NASA website about interns
  - On the National Parks website about volunteers
  - On the Facebook dating website
- The purpose of this profile is:
  - To convince the reader to donate money to NASA
  - To convince the reader that their taxes are well spent at NASA
  - To inform the reader about different programs at NASA
  - To inform the reader about different colleges in California
- Discuss with your classmates. What other purposes could this profile fulfill?
- What information is not included in this profile?
  - Felipe's educational accomplishments
  - Felipe's immigration history
  - Felipe's projects at NASA
  - Quotes that praise Felipe and his mentor
  - Information about Felipe's family

Identifying Past Tense Verbs

Read the following passage again. Identify all of the verbs. Most verbs are in the simple past tense. Why? A few are not in the simple past tense. Why not? Discuss with your instructor and classmates.

Passage One

Many students move away from home when they start college. While some move to a new city or state, NASA intern Felipe Valdez moved to a new country. In 2007, Felipe made the difficult decision to leave his home in Mexico and move to the United States to pursue his education and career. At the time, his life was at a crossroads. He could stay in Mexico, leave school, and find a full-time job, or he could move to the U.S. and have the opportunity to continue his education.

After moving to California, Felipe started his sophomore year at River Valley High School in Yuba City, about an hour outside Sacramento. Despite the challenge of integrating into a new culture and learning a new language, Felipe excelled in all his courses and graduated with an excellent GPA.

After high school, Felipe began to work on his bachelor’s degree. He first attended Yuba Community College where, in addition to earning his associate degree and graduating with honors, he received the Extended Opportunity Programs & Services Student Role Model and the Mathematics, Engineering, and Science Achievement Student of the Year awards. He then went on to study at California State University, Sacramento, where he became heavily involved on campus and received several scholarships. During his time at Sacramento State, Felipe was invited to join the Engineering Honor

Society, Tau Beta Pi. He also became a member of the Society of Hispanic Professional Engineers, the MESA Engineering Program, and the Leader Initiative Program.

Identifying Signals for Cohesion and Coherence

Examine Passage One again. This passage has many words, phrases, and clauses that help with the cohesion and coherence of the passage. Identify the words and phrases that help you understand **when** each event happened.

Cohesion and coherence are the connection of ideas at the sentence and text level. Below is the passage without signals to help with cohesion and coherence.

Passage Two

Many students move away from home when they start college. Some move to a new city or state. NASA intern Felipe Valdez moved to a new country. Felipe made the difficult decision to leave his home in Mexico. He moved to the United States. Felipe pursued his education and career. Felipe's life was at a crossroads. Felipe could stay in Mexico. Felipe could leave school. Felipe could find a full-time job. Felipe could move to the U.S. Felipe could have the opportunity to continue his education.

Felipe moved to California. Felipe started his sophomore year at River Valley High School in Yuba City. Yuba City is an hour outside Sacramento. Felipe excelled in all his courses and graduated with an excellent GPA.

Felipe began to work on his bachelor's degree. Felipe attended Yuba Community College. Felipe received the Extended Opportunity Programs & Services Student Role Model and the Mathematics, Engineering, and Science Achievement Student of the Year awards. Felipe studied at California State University, Sacramento. Felipe became heavily involved on campus. Felipe received several scholarships. At Sacramento State, Felipe was invited to join the Engineering Honor Society, Tau Beta Pi. Felipe became a member of the Society of Hispanic Professional Engineers, the MESA Engineering Program, and the Leader Initiative Program.

Practice with Signal Words for Cohesion and Coherence

With your instructor, discuss the difference in tone, style, and meaning between Passage One and Passage Two. Which passage is easier to understand? Which passage is more interesting to read? Which passage has more repetition? What's missing from the second passage?

Now fill in the missing words in Passage Two, using the information from Passage One.

Passage Two--Revised

Many students move away from home when they start college. _____ some move to a new city or state, NASA intern Felipe Valdez moved to a new country. _____, Felipe made the difficult decision to leave his home in Mexico _____move to the United States to pursue his education and career._____, his life was at a crossroads. He could stay in Mexico, leave school and find a full-time job, _____ he could move to the U.S. and have the opportunity to continue his education.

_____to California, Felipe started his sophomore year at River Valley High School in Yuba City, _____hour outside Sacramento. _____

_____, Felipe excelled in all his courses and graduated with an excellent GPA.

_____, Felipe began to work on his bachelor's degree. He _____irst attended Yuba Community College _____ _____he received the Extended Opportunity Programs & Services Student Role Model and the Mathematics, Engineering, and Science Achievement Student of the Year awards. He _____ went on to study at California State University, Sacramento, _____ became heavily involved on campus and received several scholarships. _____, Felipe was invited to join the Engineering Honor Society, Tau Beta Pi. He _____ became a member of the Society of Hispanic Professional Engineers, the MESA Engineering Program, and the Leader Initiative Program.